

Build Wonders Over Antiquated Buildings - a Wonder-placement mod for Civilization VII

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Build Wonders Over Antiquated Buildings

A Civilization VII mod. A city that filled its centre in Antiquity has nowhere left to put a Wonder. This mod lets you build one over the buildings that age left behind: urban tiles whose buildings are all from an earlier age are offered on the Wonder placement screen, the old buildings are cleared, the walls stay, and the citizens they housed are yours to place through the game's own Grow City prompt.



Figure 1: Buseoksa, built over an Amphitheater and an Academy in Leeds

The game's own Wonder cinematic for a Wonder built this way. It is an ordinary Wonder: the tile is a real `DISTRICT_WONDER`, and nothing about Wonders is redefined anywhere.

There is no database change. Wonders keep their class, their one-in-the-world uniqueness, their cinematics, their terrain rules, the adjacency their neighbours read from a Wonder district, and whatever the AI does with them. The mod clears a tile and lets the game build on it, exactly as the game would build on any bare tile.

What the player does

Pick a Wonder in production. Urban tiles holding only antiquated buildings now show as valid sites alongside the usual ones.



Figure 2: The placement screen with an antiquated tile offered and its yield preview

The placement screen, with the mod's tile selected and the yield result the mod computes for it.

Choose one, and a confirmation, titled with the Wonder's name, names the buildings that will be cleared, says how many displaced citizens you will be asked to place, and says the walls stay when the tile has any. Cancel and nothing happens.



Figure 3: The confirmation before a tile is cleared

"Amphitheater and Academy will be cleared to build Buseoksa here. You will be asked where the 2 displaced citizens settle."

Confirm, and the buildings' demolition, the district's demolition and the Wonder's build order all go to the game in the same instant, so the tile goes straight from its old buildings to the Wonder's construction site and no empty ground is ever drawn. Walls come down with the district and are re-created on the Wonder's district a moment after it lands. Once the Wonder is standing, one citizen per building that housed one becomes pending population, and before the turn can end the game's own Grow City prompt asks where each settles - a rural tile or a specialist seat, wherever you like.



Figure 4: The game's Grow City screen holding the displaced citizens

The displaced citizens arrive as ordinary pending population, placed on the game's own screen. The city's head count is unchanged once they are placed.

Which tiles qualify

Tile holds	Offered
one antiquated building, free slot or not	yes
two or more antiquated buildings	yes
one antiquated beside one current-age	no
two current-age	no
anything Ageless - the Palace, the City Hall, a Harbor, unique-quarter buildings, Wonders	no
walls, alongside any of the above	walls neither qualify a tile nor block it, and are kept

Antiquated means a previous age and not Ageless. The engine enforces none of this on its own - left alone it will offer any terrain-valid urban tile whatever stands on it - so this rule is the only thing that decides what is ever cleared. It lives in `lib/bwab-eligibility.js` with 23 tests.

Which Wonders are offered a tile

The mod decides **where** a Wonder may go. It never decides **whether** one may be built. A Wonder that is locked, not yet unlocked, or already standing somewhere in the world stays refused, exactly as the base game refuses it. Only a refusal that says there is nowhere to put it is this mod's business.

That distinction is load-bearing. Measured in one city: of 48 Wonders, 2 were buildable, 42 were refused for reasons that have nothing to do with any tile, and 4 were refused for want of a site. Only those last 4 are ones this mod can

help with.

The Wonder's own placement rules are then checked before a tile is offered for it: terrain, biome, no-feature, river (required or forbidden), adjacent terrain, adjacent district, adjacent mountain, adjacent constructible, invalid adjacent biomes, homeland or distant lands, and a required constructible in the settlement - every placement rule the game's data holds for a Wonder. A rule the mod does not evaluate excludes that Wonder rather than guessing: a Wonder that must stand on a feature, beside a lake, or on an appeal-chosen site is never offered an antiquated tile, and neither is one that uses a rule table no Wonder uses today (required or invalid features, feature classes, resources, river placement), should a future Wonder use one. So the mod will sometimes offer less than the game would allow and never more.

The five Wonders that stand on Coast follow placement rules the game keeps to itself, so a coastal urban tile (a Lighthouse or Fishing Quay) is offered to one of them only when the game already accepts that Wonder on a bare coast tile of the same city.

If the game refuses the site after all

Civilization VII will not say whether a Wonder fits a tile until the tile is empty, and it enforces placement rules that are not in the data a mod can read. So a cleared tile can still be turned down.

The build order goes to the game together with the clear, so a refusal shows up as the tile failing to become a Wonder site. The mod watches the tile for about three seconds; if the Wonder has not appeared by then, it puts the tile back: the buildings it destroyed are re-created, then the walls, and it reads the tile afterwards to confirm everything is standing. No citizens are displaced, because they are only added once the Wonder is on the tile. The hex is empty for those few seconds and then holds what it held before. Watched on a coastal Wonder whose every readable rule passed and which the engine still refused - the tile came back holding its Lighthouse, with population, urban and rural counts unchanged and nothing left pending. The cost of a refusal is a wasted confirmation, not a lost building.

The yield preview

A tile the mod adds is not one the engine prepared placement data for, so the placement panel has nothing of its own to show for it. The mod answers with its own figure, built from the game's per-constructible numbers: the Wonder's base yields, minus the yields of the buildings that would go, plus the maintenance they would stop costing.

It is a first-order figure. Yields a Wonder grants conditionally, and adjacency the old buildings were receiving, are not modelled. No Wonder in the game has adjacency rows of its own, which is why the Wonder side of the subtraction is exact.

What it costs you

The tile. Those buildings' yields and maintenance are gone, the city has fewer building slots, and the tile holds the Wonder from then on. The citizens are not lost: the head count is unchanged once you have placed them.

Compatibility

- **No database change**, so a save loads with the mod on or off, and it can join a game already in progress. A Wonder built this way is ordinary constructible state.
- **No base-game files are replaced**, and mods that adjust Wonder data are unaffected, because this mod does not touch Wonder data.
- **Your own city only**. The clear and the build are the local player's own actions on the local player's own settlement. The AI builds Wonders exactly as it always has.
- **Multiplayer**. Watched in a live LAN game: the clear, the build and the displaced citizens all went through the network session, and a competing placement was refused by the game and rolled back intact.
- English only for now. The mod's text is six strings, so a translation is a small job.

Installation

1. Subscribe on the Steam Workshop, or download the zip from the latest release.
2. Unzip it so the **build-wonders-over-antiquated-buildings** folder sits in the Civilization VII Mods directory.
3. Enable **Build Wonders Over Antiquated Buildings** from Additional Content in-game.

Status

Watched working end to end on Civilization VII 1.5.0, 2026-09-24, including a real mouse click on the hex, both the one-building and two-building cases, walls preserved on a hill tile, population conserved on both, the confirmation rendering and driving the clear, the yield preview reading on the hex and in the panel, and a refusal rolling the tile back with nothing lost, the whole thing in a live LAN game, and the tile going from its buildings straight to the Wonder's construction site with no empty ground drawn in between. Every step and the run that proved it is in docs/RECIPE.md.

Layout

build-wonders-over-antiquated-buildings.modinfo	one script, no data
ui/bwab-clear-and-build.js	the mod: placement-screen hooks, the clear, the walls, the yield preview
lib/bwab-eligibility.js	the antiquated-tile rule, engine-free, 23 tests
text/en_us/ModText.xml	name, description, the confirmation text
tests/eligibility.mjs	the rule's tests
docs/RECIPE.md	every step and the run that proved it
docs/steam-workshop-description.md	the Workshop page text
docs/logo.svg, docs/logo.png	the Workshop preview image
gallery/	the screenshots used above
devtools/README.md	where the harness lives (mod_ideas_tested) and the one command to re-ver
eslint.config.js, tsconfig.json, types/, package.json, scripts/	dev tooling, not shipped
install-dev.sh	copies the mod into the game's Mods folder
release.sh	builds dist/: the release zip, the Workshop preview and the steamcmd man
CHANGELOG.steam.txt	the Workshop change notes, kept in step with CHANGELOG.md by scripts/ste

`npm run verify` runs everything that can be checked without the game: `tsc --noEmit` over the JSDoc types, `eslint` `ui` `lib`, and the eligibility tests. Zero errors and zero warnings is the bar. `npm run readme:pdf` builds `README.pdf` from this file.

In a running game, `globalThis.__bwab.enabled = false` makes every hook pass straight through, and `globalThis.__bwab.uninstall()` restores the engine's own methods; both are for troubleshooting.

The routes that were tried and set aside, the probes, and the harness runs live in the author's working tree (`mod_ideas_tested/build_wonders_over_antiquated_buildings`), outside this repository; `devtools/README.md` lists the runs that verify this build.

Credits

Built by Tower. MIT licensed.